

智能纪要：AI时代法律专业前途

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会议主题：AI时代法律专业前途_20260413124220

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总结

Exploring the Value and Future of Legal Profession in the AI Era

Key Conclusion:

- Legal profession has broad prospects:** In the era of AI and increasing regulatory complexity, the critical thinking and problem-solving skills cultivated by legal training are irreplaceable, with diverse career paths.
- Success depends on interdisciplinary background:** Combining legal skills with knowledge in specific fields (such as technology, business, medicine) can build a strong professional moat.
- Planning should be practical and forward-looking** Law school applications should focus on T14 institutions, and stand out through well-prepared personal statements, recommendation letters and extracurricular experiences; parents should guide children to start from interest, access real industry information, and make wise choices.

Current Study Abroad and Professional Environment

Impact of STEM and AI

- STEM policies are **increasingly restrictive** for Chinese international students
- AI is replacing entry-level **STEM and finance jobs**
- Future careers require skills that **AI cannot replace**
- Regulatory complexity has created **growing demand** for legal professionals

Unique Value of Legal Profession

- The core of legal training is cultivating **critical thinking**
- Critical thinking is the ability to **analyze problems from multiple perspectives**
- This ability is a **general skill** for navigating a complex world
- Legal background is **common among top business and political leaders**

Career Development Path in Law

Career Start

- Most graduates start at **top law firms**
- Experience **high-intensity work for about 5 years**
- Build a solid **professional and practical foundation**

Diversified Development

- Move to in-house counsel or **strategy roles in corporations**
- Enter government, non-profits or **think tanks**
- Become an independent consultant or **found a boutique firm**

Compound Advantage

- Combine **legal skills with industry knowledge**
- Examples: pharmaceuticals + patent law, **AI technology + regulation**
- Build a deep **professional moat**

Law School Application and Selection

Evaluation Dimension	Core Requirements	Specific Suggestions
Academic GPA	Undergraduate grades and course difficulty	Largely predetermined, serves as important foundation

Academic Criteria	Undergraduate Grades and Course Difficulty	Law School Admission
LSAT	High score is critical threshold	Requires targeted preparation and practice
Recommendation Letters	Complementary letters showing growth and uniqueness	Requires careful planning, in-depth communication with recommenders
Personal Statement	Clear vision of using law to change the world	Needs to be sincere, specific, showing passion and planning
Extracurricular Experience	Differentiated internships, papers or language skills	Proves exploration and commitment to legal field

Advice for Parents and Students

💡 Stimulating Interest in Law

- Start from issues your child cares about, not **abstract legal topics**
- Position law as a **tool for solving practical problems**
- Create opportunities to **connect with industry professionals**
- Broaden understanding of the legal industry through **authentic conversations**

🎯 Strategic Planning and Mindset

- There is a clear **ranking divide** among law schools (T14 as benchmark)
- Encourage building **interdisciplinary skill combinations** (e.g., JD+MBA)
- Parents should continue learning and **maintain an open mindset**
- Avoid **closing doors prematurely** for your children

Content generated by AI

The video focused on the career choices for students in the current era, especially considering the impact of AI and the changing situation of STEM education for Chinese students in the US. Bill, a professor at the University of Pennsylvania Law School, shared his insights on law education, career prospects, and school selection. The content is as follows:

- **Career Choices in the AI and STEM Context**
 - **Impact of AI and STEM Trends**
 - **STEM Evolution:** Bill pointed out that STEM is evolving rapidly, and much of it may be replaced by AI itself. For example, many entry - level jobs in big banks can now be done by AI. Students who are not extraordinary in STEM may find it difficult to catch up if they start studying it now.
 - **Alternative Career Paths:** He suggested that law is a great field as the world is becoming more complex, and there is an increasing need for regulation in areas such as AI and medical breakthroughs. For instance, in the medical field, it's not only about making medical breakthroughs but also about patenting and controlling their use, which requires legal knowledge.
 - **Parental Concerns and Student Choices**
 - **STEM vs. Humanities:** Matthew, as a parent, shared his family's experience of struggling between STEM and humanities for his children. He emphasized that parents should consider multiple paths for their children and not be overly focused on STEM.

- Long - term Planning: Parents should look at the long - term trends and help their children make choices that can withstand the test of time. For example, in the finance field, understanding regulatory environments and geopolitical futures, which are skills learned in law school, will be crucial for future success.

- **Law School Education and Career Prospects**

- **Skills Taught in Law School**

- Critical Thinking: Bill believes that the most important thing law school teaches is critical thinking. Through the case - method in the classroom, students learn to analyze problems from multiple perspectives. For example, in class, he asks students a series of questions to challenge their assumptions and force them to think deeper.
 - Practical Application: Law school graduates can apply their critical thinking skills in various fields. Many high - level positions in society are held by people with law degrees, such as the COO of major global businesses.

- **Career Paths for Law School Graduates**

- Initial Employment: Most law school graduates start their careers at large global law firms, where they learn the practical skills of law. They can choose different areas of specialization, such as AI regulation, international finance, or media law.
 - Diverse Career Directions: After a few years, graduates may choose different paths. Some may become in - house counsel for businesses, advising on legal and strategic matters. Others may work in the non - profit sector, government, or open their own boutique law firms.

- **Law School Selection**

- **T14 Law Schools**

- Significance of T14: In the US, the T14 law schools are considered the top - tier institutions. Bill mentioned that Georgetown is often seen as the cutoff at the bottom of the T14. Getting into a T14 school is valuable as it provides better networking opportunities and job prospects.
 - Clusters within T14: There are two clusters within the T14. The top cluster includes schools like Penn, Columbia, NYU, Harvard, Yale, and Stanford, while the next cluster includes schools like Duke, Chicago, Berkeley.

Factor Category	Key Factors	Controllability
Academic Performance	• GPA • LSAT	Generally uncontrollable for applicants ready to apply
Application Materials	• Recommendation Letters • Essays	Controllable; need strategic planning and sincere expression
Extracurricular Experience	• Internships • Published Papers • Special Language Skills	Controllable; should align with law school interests and show dedication

A strong essay can help borderline applicants stand out, and recommendation letters should be complementary to showcase the applicant's overall strengths.

AI-generated

Law School Admission Factors

- **Admission Requirements**

- Five Key Factors: Law school admissions offices consider five main factors: GPA, LSAT, recommendation letters, essays, and extracurricular activities. For example, a great essay can sometimes tip the balance for a borderline applicant.
- Controllable and Uncontrollable Factors: For students getting ready to apply, GPA and LSAT may be set. However, they can control their recommendation letters, essays, and what they do between now and the application. For recommendation letters, they should be complementary and show the whole person. Essays should show the applicant's passion for using law to make a difference.
- **Inspiring Interest in Law**
 - **Starting from Problems**
 - Problem - Solving Approach: Bill suggested that to make students interested in law, start with the problems they care about. For example, if a student is concerned about climate change, they can see how law can be used to address this issue.
 - Industry Exposure: Matthew shared that his son Andrew had limited knowledge about law until he met Bill. Meeting with industry experts can help students gain a better understanding of law and its potential in their future careers.
 - **Avoiding Over - Reliance on AI:** Bill warned that AI has limitations, especially in predicting the future. It may make up information and is not as reliable as human interaction. For example, when his students use AI to write, they often get it wrong.
- **Future Plans:** The next meeting will be held next Friday at noon. A well - known public speaking expert will be invited to give a live class on how to improve speaking skills to meet American standards.

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待办

☐ 学费情况查询：查询宾大的 MBA 加 JD 项目的学费是付一份还是两份

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智能章节

00:00 开场

| 开场

06:33 Matthew与Bill介绍个人经历及教育背景

本章节中，说话人2介绍自己是Matthew，两个孩子从上海到美国读书，自己是80年代赴美留学生，有咨询和投资行业经历。说话人3是Bill Burkwein，是美国宾夕法尼亚大学法学院教授，有丰富教学与研究经历，还曾为美国政府工作，参与实际法律案件，能将现实经验带入课堂，也会代表公司打国际法商务官司。

12:01 中美留学现状：学生签证发放正常，敏感专业受限

本章节主要围绕与Bill的交谈内容及美国留学现状展开。说话人2将以家长身份与Bill交流，探讨在AI时代和美国对中国STEM留学生不友好背景下家长和学生的选择。还提及特朗普政府给国际生带来的影响，实际上学生仍可正常申请和获得签证，只是社交媒体发言需注意，敏感专业签证较难获批，学校管理运行正常。

17:42 STEM与AI时代下学生未来专业选择建议

本章节围绕为年轻学生未来10到20年规划展开讨论。说话人3认为学生应基于自身优势选择，若擅长数学可投身STEM。但STEM发展快，易被自身及AI替代。他觉得法律是不错选择，因世界愈发复杂，政府监管、AI和医学等领域都需法律规范，法律不会被轻易替代。

23:32 法学教育、职业出路与批判性思维探讨

本章节围绕法律行业发展及法学院教育展开讨论。指出法学院注重培养学生批判性思维，即从多维度分析问题、解决问题的能力。毕业生多先进入律所，后发展方向多样。还探讨了JD学位价值，虽入门级工作可无此学历，但考虑AI冲击和行业监管需求，JD能提供职业护城河，顶尖机构也看重此类人才。

44:57 子女教育规划及宾大跨专业项目探讨

本章节围绕孩子教育规划展开讨论。有人认为介绍顶尖机构对中等家庭孩子不实际，但也指出普通孩子有规划也可发展良好。家长不应自我设限，要为孩子多探索路径，如法律与其他专业结合。还介绍了宾大跨专业项目，如JD MBA等，强调孩子才华组合应多元，以增强不可替代性。

01:02:28 美国法学院T14、T6划分及就读价值探讨

本章节围绕法学院选择展开讨论。提到美国法学院有T14之分，乔治城是T14底线，T14内又分两档，T6如哈佛、耶鲁等为顶尖。低于T14除非有特定目标，否则不建议就读。与本科不同，法学院T14和其他学校差距明显，体现在教学氛围和机会上，选校需考虑成本和收益。

01:09:12 申请法学院的五项关键要素及现实要求

本章节围绕进入法学院的要求展开讨论。说话人询问国际中国学生进入前14法学院的现实要求，说话人3指出法学院招生办公室会看五样东西，即GPA、LSAT考试成绩、推荐信、个人文书以及校外经历，如实习、写论文、掌握特殊语言等，还提到文书写得好的可能增加入学机会。

01:12:30 法学院申请可控与不可控因素解析

本章节围绕法学院申请的可控与不可控因素展开讨论。对于多数准备申请的学生，GPA和LSAT已成过去。可控因素有三：一是推荐信，要精心规划，各推荐信互补展现完整的自己；二是文书，真诚阐述用法律改变世界的具体想法；三是申请前的行动，如优质实习、发表论文等，展现兴趣与投入。

01:18:02 探讨让孩子对法律感兴趣的方法与途径

本章节围绕如何让孩子对法律感兴趣展开讨论。有人认为不要直接谈法律，应从孩子关心的问题入手，把法律作为解决问题的工具。也有人提出让孩子认识法律领域的专家，与之交流，像被哈佛和斯坦福同时录取的学生，其家长就带他与各界人士交流。还提到家长可对孩子采取“挑战”和“暴露”的方式引导。

01:23:06 AI使用探讨与家长自我成长及活动安排

本章节讨论了AI的使用和家长成长等话题。说话人认为AI目前虽能总结历史，但对未来预测能力为零，使用需谨慎，更提倡人跟人的交流。还提到家长要自我成长，给孩子足够多的见识。此外，透露下个星期五中午将邀请一位厉害的美国公众演讲者来上课，最后大家互相致谢并期待下次相聚。

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关键决策

- **Key Decision:** In the context of the AI era and the US's unfriendly attitude towards Chinese students studying STEM, students and parents should consider humanities, especially law, as an alternative option.
 - **Problem:** In the current situation where AI is prevalent and the US has restrictions on Chinese students studying STEM, students and parents are faced with the problem of choosing a suitable career path and major.
 - **Discussion Options:**
 - Speaker 2 and Speaker 1 raised concerns about the future development of students under the influence of AI and the US policy towards STEM majors.
 - Speaker 3 suggested that students should build on their strengths. For those with strong mathematical abilities, STEM may still be a good choice. However, considering the rapid evolution of STEM and the potential replacement by AI, law is a promising field as it is needed for the regulation of new technologies and complex government regulations.
 - Regarding law school applications, Speaker 3 mentioned that law school admissions offices consider five factors: GPA, LSAT, recommendation letters, essays, and extracurricular activities. And for students getting ready to apply, they can control recommendation letters, essays, and what they do between now and the application.

- **Decision Basis:** The rapid development of AI and the increasing complexity of government regulations make law an important field. Law can provide students with critical thinking skills and a wide range of career opportunities. Also, the current situation of STEM majors being restricted in the US makes it necessary for students to explore other options.
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- **Other Decisions:**

- a. In the US, the T14 law schools are considered more valuable. Georgetown is seen as the cutoff for the T14. If students want to work in a specific region, they can choose a local law school even if it is not in the T14.
- b. To get students interested in law, start with the problems they care about and let them realize that law is a tool to solve these problems. Also, having in - depth communication with professionals in the legal field can help students understand law better.

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金句时刻

「My first answer is, it's gonna be different for every student. And to thrive, you gotta build on your strength.」

— This quote emphasizes the importance of students building on their own strengths when choosing a career path, which is a key point in the discussion about future study and career choices.

「I think the most important thing is student learns either in college or in graduate square is critical thinking. It's how to think. It's how to take the problem and solve it. And that's actually what you learn in law school.」

— This quote highlights the core value of law school education, which is to cultivate students' critical thinking ability, and it is a unique and important aspect of legal education.

「Start with a problem you wanna solve, because law fundamentally is a tool to help you solve problems, to help you make change.」

— This quote provides a practical approach to getting students interested in law, which is to connect law with real - world problems, making law more tangible and appealing.

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